Detective Mermista in: Mer-mysteries the birthday surprise

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/42530826.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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Additional Tags:
Pretty much everyone is here - Freeform, Birthday, Canon Compliant, Post-Canon, Surprise Party, Murder Mystery, Detective Mermista, Birthday Presents, Stan Mermista, Fluff, No One Is Dead btw

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by ChaoticAroAce

Summary

When Mermista enters the salon for what was apparently an emergency meeting, she's met with the sight of a seemingly ''dead" Glimmer. Upon further inspection of the fake wound on her neck and reading the letter in her hand, it becomes clear.
This is a case for detective Mermista.

A witty story where Mermista gets to play detective, experience a night of joy and love, and have fun with her friends on her birthday.

Now featuring: Entrapta and the case of the stolen biscuits.

(written for Mermista's birthday)

Notes

IT'S MERMISTA'S BIRTHDAY!

So naturally I had to write about it.

I actually came up with this exactly a year ago, on her birthday (duh). Then I forgot about it, until I got reminded that her birthday was coming up again, so I pulled it back out from the very back off my brain; and now we're here.

See the end of the work for more notes

Mermista stormed through the halls of the castle, why Glimmer decided it would be a good idea to schedule a last-minute emergency meeting on her birthday, she'd never understand.

So this better be important or else-

She opened the wide doors to the salon.

It was dark, the only light source in the room was the freshly lit fireplace.

That was...odd.

Emergency meeting my ass, she was the only one there. Glimmer was going to pay for this. This sort of prank was low. (Even for someone as short as Glimmer.)

She stepped into the room, the doors closing behind her with a soft *thunk*. Her eyes wandered around the room, landing on the couch.

Glimmer was...laying? there. She had heard Bow talk about how weirdly Glimmer slept. But she was sure that was not what he meant by that. Or at least she hoped, because that was kind of creepy. She was more like sitting all floppy on there, lifeless, as if every muscle in her body had suddenly decided to stop working.

Mermista walked over to her, as worry started to kick in.

Okay, her chest was rising and falling, that was good...Her closed eyes were- twitching, and Mermista caught her tapping her foot

once or twice. It became clearer to her what was actually happening here; Glimmer was pretending to be dead.

Mermista decided play along. ‘’Oh no, Glimmer’s dead.” she said in her usual uninterested tone.

She could’ve sworn she heard Glimmer quietly scoff at that. Jeez, sorry her acting skills weren’t adequate to the queen’s standards.

She took a look at Glimmer again, as to ‘inspect the subject’. There was a letter in her hand. She should probably read that first. Mermista carefully slipped the letter out of Glimmer’s hand, opened the seal, and read it.

Dear Detective Mermista,

Our dearest queen has been killed!

It happened earlier this very evening.

It is up to you to catch the murderer. If you do you must stick this sticker onto them.

There was a sticker attached to the bottom right corner of the paper. The thing looked like it was pulled straight out of Glimmer's diary.

Mermista grinned, whoever wrote the letter though, was definitely not Glimmer, as it was way too legible for that. Neither was it Perfuma, not nearly enough flourishes.

Not that it mattered.

She got closer to Glimmer. Maybe she had some clues as to how she's been killed on her person? It was hard to see in the dark, but Mermista could make out a line on her neck reaching from underneath her jaw almost to her chin. There was, what appeared to be dried up blood, (though it probably wasn't real, it would be for the sake of this) made sense considering that it happened a couple hours ago.

The fact that her neck was cut open in such a clean line, gave her an idea of what the murder weapon could've been. It obviously had to be something quite sharp.

The first thing that came to mind was sword or a dagger which would point to Adora, or maybe even Catra, since they were dating it probably wouldn't be hard for her to steal the sword. Although she wasn't entirely sure how the sword worked, since it technically wasn't feasible anymore, so if it had been Catra it had to be with the dagger.

Maybe with an arrow, she thought. This would obviously point to Bow, since he was pretty much the only one who owned them. Plus he made them himself so he could very well make one that was extra sharp, for this purpose. Was it morbid to accuse her boyfriend of this? Maybe. But everyone was a possible suspect in this situation.

Mermista tried to think of more possible things that one would consider sharp.

An ice dagger maybe? Frosta could easily make those herself in a matter of seconds, so it didn't seem too unrealistic. There was no water around though.

There wasn’t really anything laying around.

The murderer must’ve taken it with them or gotten rid of it, there was like a wall of giant windows in here after all.

Mermista made her way out of the room, she needed to interview a few suspects if she wanted to get further along in this case.

She could hear a few of her friends playing outside, so she decided that was who she was going to question first.

She stepped out on the grass of the royal garden’s volleyball court, where five of her friends were gathered (well, four friends and an annoying horse, but details); sweating and playing volleyball. They turned to look at her as she made her way over to them.

‘’Where were you when the murder happened?” She hissed at Netossa, who looked at her with a quirked brow: ‘’Murder?”

‘’The queen is dead, she was killed a few hours ago. I need to know what you were doing during that time.” She explained.

‘’Well-” Netossa began explaining ‘’ We’ve been playing volleyball pretty much all evening.”

‘’The whole evening?” Who in their right mind would spend an entire evening playing volleyball? Like she could get behind a couple of rounds but a whole evening. Without leaving the field once to grab snacks or drinks or a book? Weird.

They all nodded. ‘’And at what exact time did you guys start?” She questioned. It was still possible that they started after she had been killed. ‘All evening’ could really mean anything.

‘’About 3pm.” Netossa estimated. Well that was definitely before the murder.

Mermista nodded looking thoughtful ‘’And each and every one of you has been here playing since then?” A chorus of yeahs, yesses and mhms followed. Mermista nodded again and looked over at Swiftwind who she internally had tuned out as soon as she walked over to them. ‘’And that includes him?” She knew it wasn’t Swiftwind, literally how, would it be him.

Swiftwind sprung forward: ‘’Yes, I have been playing with them, thank you very much.” She already regretted talking to him.

‘’You... Where playing volleyball?” She looked at him and then at his lack of hands.

‘’Yes!”

‘’How would you even... you don’t....” She mumbled ‘’Guys has he been here the entire time?” She called over to the others, who nodded in response. ‘’Whatever...” She walked off.

On her way back to the castle she ran into Perfuma, who was tending the flowers in the royal garden, she would always comment on how sad the flowers in the garden looked, Glimmer would always respond with how that wasn’t a priority at the moment since she had better things to do, which had owned her a couple of exasperated gasps.

Maybe the flower princess had finally had enough and turned to revenge.

Mermista was greeted with an enthusiastic wave and bright smile as she walked up to her.

‘’Mermista how have you been?”

‘’Uh good. Listen, Glimmer’s dead; someone murdered her. I’m interviewing potential suspects.” Mermista redirected the conversation, small talk was not what she needed right now. ‘’So tell me Perfuma, where were you and what were you doing a couple of hours ago?”

‘’Oh I just got here about half an hour ago.” She stated. Which was true; Mermista had seen her arrive with a full basket in her arms, she had wondered whether there was a present in there for her and then reminded herself that she was a 26-year-old woman who did not need presents for her birthday.

‘’Have you seen anything or anyone suspicious since you got here?” Mermista continued her interview.

Perfuma thought about it for a second and then shook her head. ‘’Ooh but I could help you on your search, as your partner in *not*-crime. Get it because we’re solving one.” Mermista sighed.

‘’I’m good, so no thanks.” She tried to make her leave before the other woman got any more ideas. Next thing you know, they’d be having code names and secret passcodes. Which now that she thought about it did sound pretty cool, but not right now; she told herself.

‘’Well then-‘’ Perfuma moved on with her gardening, only looking half the kicked puppy Mermista thought she would. ‘’have you by chance seen Frosta?”

‘’Oh yeah, she’s over there playing Volleyball with the others.” Mermista gestured behind her with her head, not looking back.

Perfuma narrowed her eyes looking behind her confused. Maybe she needed glasses.

Mermista re-entered the castle making her way over to the war room, which had been turned into a make-shift lab by Entrapta and a few of her friends, it appeared. She looked around the room to see who was there. Entrapta seemed to be working on another new robot. Next to her sat Scorpia who seemed to be animatedly telling her some story about a camp she and Perfuma had been visiting over the weekend, with Entrapta nodding along as she spoke. Wrong Hordak sat on one of the chairs carefully listening along to what Scorpia had to say. And sadly Hordak was also there, probably helping Entrapta or whatever.

‘’Hey guys.” She waved as she walked into the room, but sounded as uninterested as always.

They all looked over at her, stopping whatever they were doing. Scorpia waved back at her.

‘’I want to know what you were doing a couple of hours ago.” She spoke to them.

‘’Oh, I was helping out in the kitchen and came here to help my friends once I was done there.” Wrong Hordak was the first one to speak up.

‘’What where you making?” Mermista asked curios, this was not really that important, she was just hungry.

‘’Oh just some sweets.” He blushed.

Mermista slowly nodded.

‘’Would you like some?” He added, handing her a tray of tiny muffins. Mermista silently took one.

‘’Anyways, what were the others up to?” She spoke before plopping the muffin into her mouth. Man that was fire, the guy sure knew what he was doing in the kitchen.

Entrapta took her mask off. ‘’I’ve been working on this new robot, it can shoot confetti, clean said confetti up, he can also dance, aaand the best part is the integrated party lights” She pressed a button and the room got illuminated with colourful moving lights, Entrapta squealed.

Okay... That was pretty cool. Didn't seem that helpful, but fun nonetheless.

Mermista looked over to Scorpia. ‘’Well, I was just keeping Entrapta company” She stated as Entrapta nodded.

‘’I was helping out Entrapta with the bot.” Hordak chimed in.

She turned around to glare at him, Hordak looking rather unphased, he was probably like used to it at this point.

‘’Uh huh, how am I supposed to know that that isn’t just a lie...” She continued glaring.

‘’Well, you could ask them.” He gestured towards the others.

‘’Yep!” responded Entrapta, followed by a nod from Scorpia.

‘’What if, you snuck out while no one was looking and just quickly killed the queen, because that sounds exactly like something you would do.”

Hordak just looked at her. That’s what I thought, wimp.

‘’Mermista. We can assure you that he was in fact here the entire time. We were talking and programming the whole time.” Scorpia cut in, ‘’I know you still don’t trust him after he, you know, destroyed your kingdom...” Mermista looked down at the floor to hide the grief in her eyes. Ugh. That was years ago, why was she still mad? ‘’And no one expects you two to be best friends. You’re not obligated to forgive him. It’s fine that you still don’t trust him, but at least trust us. It’s not fair of you to just blame him for it because of things he has done in the past, okay?”

‘’Ugh fine” She groaned and walked out of there.

Maybe it had been rude of her to just storm out of there like that. And maybe she had been in the wrong for jumping to conclusions. Especially ones that were so far-fetched.

She sighed; she was still getting nowhere with this case.

She passed the wall of murals and went up the stairs, back to where she was at the beginning. Great. Glimmers guard was standing opposite to the door of the salon. How come they didn't notice the queen died? Maybe they had, but then what where they doing there? They must have seen something right?

‘’Where were you when the murder happened?” Mermista asked Glimmer’s apparent ‘top guard’.

‘’Excuse me?” Julia? Jules?(Mermista still didn't know her name, but she was fairly sure she didn't know hers either so it was fine) responded.

‘’Oh please, as if you wouldn’t notice the queen dying. Isn’t it like, your literal job to guard and protect her.” It was very suspicious if you were asking her.

The guard straightened and spoke: ‘’All I did was my job. We had seen Glimmer enter the salon alive and well minutes before she got killed.”

‘’And no one entered after her?” Mermista questioned.

‘’No ma’am” She shook her head.

‘’And did you check to see if the room was empty before she entered?”

‘’We saw no one else enter the room before nor after.” She stated

Well that was weird, the only other thing Mermista could think of was that someone was already in the room, but the guards were on duty all day around, someone had to have entered the room at some point; right?

As she continued down the hall, she tried to think of more suspects she could question. Bow, seemed unlikely since he was Bow. But maybe he knew something about it. It was worth a shot.

She could hear hammering as she approached Bows workshop. She quickly knocked and waited for a response. The noise stopped and she could make out Bow sprinting to the door. ‘’Oh, hey Mermista!” He greeted as he opened the door. She stepped into the workshop and inspected it a bit. It was extremely warm in here, despite Brightmoon’s low temperatures at night, that was probably due to the machinery that was required to manipulate metal. On his work-bench were multiple arrow heads and other knickknacks.

‘’How long have you been working in here for?”

Bow looked touched, at the thought of her being worried about him. ‘’About five hours.”

‘’So before the murder?” She snapped him right out of that thought.

‘’Murder??” His voice slightly cracked.

‘’Ugh yes, there has been a murder, Glimmers dead, blah blah.” Man how many times would she have to explain this? Ugh.

Bow’s eyes were wide open and so was his mouth and Mermista couldn’t quite tell if he was acting or not.

‘’Well, as I said I’ve been here pretty much all evening.” Bow stammered

‘’Well did you see anything suspicious? Or anyone” She asked, Bow seemed to think about it for a while. ‘’I don’t know if this will help you in any way, but Frosta came in here looking for one of my failed arrow prototypes.”

What?

‘’I gave one to her, I mean I don’t have much use for them anyway.” He continued.

What.

But Frosta was out Playing with the other four.

This wasn’t adding up, either Bow was lying to her, which she was sure, wasn’t physically possible, or Frosta was... but the others did vow that she was with them. What if they were lying? But why would they do that if they weren't in on it? Maybe they were and it was some sort of group assassination. Just like in Mer-mysteries the lying swarm.

But why would a teenager kill their best friend? Frosta would never help with something like that.

Maybe neither of them were...Which would have to mean there was someone going around impersonating the others, someone

like a shapeshifter.

Double Trouble.

She'd just have to figure out where that idiot was hiding. Or rather as who.

Just don't trust anyone they could be anywhere.

This was going to be easy; she was basically raised like this.

She turned around the corner. Where Sea Hawk was doing whatever Sea Hawks do when they're bored.

Not trusting anyone included not trusting her husband. And yeah, Mermista may trust him all she wants, but Detective Mermista won't.

She had to just remind herself that there was a chance that this wasn't her amazing, caring, and loving husband and instead a kingdom destroying snitch.

And if anyone could figure out which of the two it was, it would be her. She knew him better than she knew herself, and so did he. She'd just have to exploit that.

‘’Hey” She walked over to him, brushing the back of his hand with hers.

‘’Hello” He smiled, but it didn't seem as sincere as it normally was. ‘’How are you dearest?”

She sighed and let herself lean onto his shoulder.

That usually brought her the feeling of comfort and warmth, it didn't this time. It almost felt cold, literally. Very odd considering the man was pretty much a walking radiator.

And wow, not even an arm around the shoulder? Harsh.

‘’I just feel like I’m getting nowhere with this, you know?”

He made a sound of agreement.

She got an idea, ”Hey Sea Hawk?” She practically never called him that, she wondered if he caught on. ‘’Could you get me something to drink, I feel like I need it.”

‘’Of course.” He answered before turning around taking a couple steps and turning back around, lips pursed and eyebrows slightly raised, as if wanting to ask a question.

‘’In our drawers.” It came out sounding more like a question rather than a fact.

‘’Right.” He turned back around, still sounding slightly confused, but not asking anymore questions. Sea Hawk knew where they stored their drinks. Of course he knew. She knew for a fact that he knew. Whenever they’d stay at Brightmoon they’d store their drinks in a bag in the bottom drawer of their dresser, along with their socks, underwear, and whatnot. They’ve been storing them in there since forever. Just in case their friends would get the idea of stealing their drinks.

The bag usually contained two things: Their absolute favourite and a drink Mermista absolutely despised, which is always given to them at trade meetings and boring gathering.

It was just a matter of waiting to see which one he’d bring out. There was no way, *her husband* would bring out the one she didn't like. Well except for when he was feeling extra goofy and spontaneously decided to annoy her for absolutely no reason other than being an absolute pain in the ass. But he knew when and where to do things like that and that was not in a situation like this one-

Her string of thoughts got interrupted by him reappearing in the doorframe. She looked down to see what he was holding in his hands.

The wrong drink.

Bingo!

That was all the confirmation she needed. She walked closer to Sea Hawk, or well, not Sea Hawk. ‘’Thanks...” She spoke softly, placing a hand on their chest, in hopes of making them think she got fooled for even a second. She went to whisper in their ear. ‘’Murderer.”

And with that placed the sticker on their neck.

She turned around with a cheeky smile at seeing them taken aback for a second.

She heard Double Trouble scowl and turned back in time to watch them de-transform.

‘’Bravo.” They bowed, ‘’And to think, that I thought I almost had you. What gave it away? Be honest.”

‘’Oh please, I’m like, married to the guy. So I think I can like obviously tell. I know the way he talks when were alone, the faces he pulls when he’s thinking, the little things.” Mermista rolled her eyes half-heartedly, a small smile tugging at her lips from just thinking about him. Ugh sap.

‘’Also, I like hate that drink you brought with my guts, so...” She added.

They almost looked offended by that last statement, but dismissed it quickly.

‘’Anyways, I’d be going into dramatic retelling of how I murdered the queen if you’re willing to listen.”

‘’Ugh please do, that’s like my second favourite part after the reveal of how they caught the murderer.”

‘’So here’s what happened-‘’ They started their monologue looking out into the distance, which in their case was literally just at a wall, a tiny window with a potted plant sitting on the window sill. But whatever they need to do to be like, dramatic, or whatever. ‘’ The first step was to lure Glitter into the salon, which I did by transforming into her guard and informing her to wait in there as her little arrow boyfriend has a surprise planned for her. Let’s be honest Shimmer could never resist that.

I then transformed into Ice princess and got one of Bow’s arrows. With my murder weapon in tow I transformed into the queen, just so none of the guards would get suspicious.

The next part was easy, I just had to slice open her neck and let her die a painful and slow death, then I locked the door so she couldn’t escape before she died. And because I’m a master escape artist, I escaped without anyone seeing me.” They finished their little retelling off.

‘’Uhh the door wasn’t locked though?” Mermista was going to ignore the fact that Glimmer could have easily teleported herself out of there, even if it had been.

‘’Um, it’s called ‘to pretend’ darling” They replied with their typical attitude.

They led Mermista down to the ballroom, which was pitch black as they entered. Once the door had shut behind them, a ball of sparkly magic unmistakeably Glimmer’s, shot up and illuminated

the whole room in a pink glow. Infront of her stood all of her friends.

‘’SURPRISE!” They all yelled, Mermista had to bite back a smile.

Okay, Mermista had figured out a while ago that this was for her birthday. And a surprise party would be totally cringey and lame if these weren’t her friends and she wasn’t secretly a total softie.

The Ballroom, now cleared of its giant tables and instead equipped with a few smaller round tables, had been decorated with flowers and sculptures of all sorts. There were a kelp bar and a regular one set up in the room, Mermista grinned. They knew her so well.

She noticed Catra walking up to her. She hadn’t seen her the entire afternoon, she probably helped setting this up, she mused. She was wearing a pinstriped suit in a rich burgundy colour, not bad.

‘’Hey fish sticks!” The feline greeted.

‘’Friendly as ever.” Mermista rolled her eyes playfully.

Catra laughed ‘’Yeah, well... I don’t really know how to start here, so bear with me?”

Mermista nodded.

‘’Although I’ve apologized a few times already-‘’ A few being pretty much every time Salineas or Catra came up in a meeting. ‘’and helped with rebuilding Salineas, I still feel like I needed to make it up to you. And when I heard the story off the Mer-mystery night I thought it would be a good opportunity, to turn the horrid memory into a positive one full of joy and love; you know? So I came up with a story and let the staff and our friends in on it. And uh we all worked together to make it like actually happen.” Catra disclosed

‘’So have fun and kiss that stupid husband of yours.” She added.

‘’Thanks horde-scum, even though I’m still kinda mad about it, you really proved yourself with this. Maybe you’re not as bad as I thought.” She smiled at her, like a genuine smile.

‘’I’ll take it.” Catra laughed ‘’And happy birthday, by the way.” She wished her, before she walked off.

Mermista did as she got told and walked up to her stupid husband to kiss that stupid moustached face of his. He was wearing a black tuxedo with navy accents and gold buttons, similar to the one he wore to the grotto once. She was not lying when she said that that vest did wonders on him.

The sleeves of his undershirt were rolled up to above his elbow, showing off his forearms. The parts of his arms that weren't exposed were nicely filling in the undershirt.

Sea Hawk wore an amused smile on his face, obviously catching her checking him out.

''What? Am I not allowed to appreciate my husband anymore?" She rolled her eyes at him.

''Oh you're allowed to appreciate me *however* you'd like." He winked. Idiot. She smacked him across his chest, which earned her a small chuckle.

''You look beautiful dearest." Wow he was one to talk, considering he was all dressed up and she wasn't. As a matter of fact, everyone was dressed up except for her.

''Uh I'm like the only one who isn't dressed up here."

''Doesn't matter, you're still the most beautiful person in this room."

Sea Hawk and his corny ass lines, that should've not gotten her as flustered as it did.

‘’But if you are feeling like changing, I may or may not have packed you something.”

‘’You have?” He nodded. Of course he would think to do something like this; how was an idiot like him simultaneously the most thoughtful person on all of Etheria?

‘’Does my darling wife fancy a change of attire?” He bowed dramatically.

She sighed and grabbed him by the wrist pulling him out of the room ‘’Let’s just go, you goober.”

A wave of incense burnings and burnt wax hit them, as they entered the dimly lit guest room The lit candles sure made for a great atmosphere. Mermista instantly slumped down onto the bed. Seahawk went to lay beside her. They stayed like that for a while until Mermista rolled over, laying on top of him, her lips against his, then her hands were tangled in his hair, his on her waist pulling her closer to him, you get the picture.

‘’I should probably get dressed now.” She pulled away, remembering the actual reason they were even here. Would’ve been kind of weird if Mermista was missing for most of her own party. He moved over to the dresser handing her a beautiful navy blue lehenga choli with golden accents at the hem of the skirt and top, it which matched his tux, she noted. She didn't recall owning something quite like this, maybe he got it for her.

As Mermista was pleating and pinning the dupatta in place, Sea Hawk got out a nicely wrapped present. ‘’I wanted to give it to you now so you could already wear it.” He explained with a small smile as he dropped it into her lap.

‘’Darling, you seriously didn't have to give me anything.”

‘’Sh- I wanted to.”

She carefully opened the box and peered inside. Nestled in there was a new set of vambraces; and nice ones too. Mermista had to discard her old ones after the war, they had gotten completely wrecked from Prime’s weird fluid baths and didn't really fulfil their purpose anymore. She had kind of missed wearing them.

They were made out pure gold, which they had collected while adventuring a few years back. The same gold their wedding bands were made out of. Every inch of them was covered with intricate patterns and designs. Their names were even engraved on the inside of one of them.

‘’I know it’s not a lot but-‘’

‘’Not a lot?” Mermista could already feel the tears threatening to fall. ‘’Sea Hawk, what do you think I expected from you? Your first born and a private island?”

He chuckled. She smiled at him.

‘’Like seriously though, Thank you.”

She walked towards him, taking his shirt collar in between her fingers and fidgeting with it. ‘’I think we should head back; it’d be a real shame if we looked this good and no one would be around to see it.”

He grinned and pulled her in for one last kiss, before taking her hand and leading her back to the ballroom.

After a while of chatting Mermista finally made her way over to the kelp bar. She’d told the others she’d be right back, she just really wanted to get some-

‘’Mermista!” A shrill voice snapped her out of her thought.

‘’Entrapta, you scared the shit out of me! I almost dropped my plate.”

Entrapta ignored Mermista’s complaints and cut right to the chase. ‘’I’m here to bring forward a very serious issue. Someone, has been stealing my tiny biscuits. I’ve been informed by trustworthy sources that you are an expert detective that can solve any case.” Her voice was suddenly much quieter and lower, she was clearly

taking whatever role she'd assigned herself very seriously. ''This is a case for detective Entrapta and detective Mermista!"

Uhhh

Absolutely not

Mermista had had enough mysteries for one day. She decided and promptly walked away from the bar.

''So what should we do first, detective?" Entrapta followed pulling out her recorder.

Ughhh

''Uh look out for anything suspicious?" It sounded more like a question rather than an answer.

''Okay. Sounds great." With that the ~~inventor~~ detective walked off.

What the fuck?

''Ok, who of you told Entrapta to bother me with her biscuit problem?" She walked up to her friends, now with a fully stacked plate.

They all looked down. Of course.

After a while of talking and laughing Mermista went back to the bar, this time to get Glimmer some napkins as the pink ball of glitter, people called their queen, had snorted into her wine glass and was now covered in red wine.

Sea Hawk also came along, because the man kept stealing her food after saying he didn't want any.

''Do you happen to know who stole my biscuits?" She overheard Entrapta interrogating her next victim.

''D-Do I know who stole your biscuits? Uhhhh nooo? H- Haven't seen a thing!" That would be Adora.

''Are you lying to me?"

''Uh, no?"

''Okay good, for a second there I thought you were."

‘’Care for a dance, my queen?” Mermista had been so focused listening in on the other conversation, she hadn’t even noticed that people had already started dancing. Mermista smirked and took his hand.

He wasted no time sweeping her onto the dance floor, placing a hand at her waist as she slung her arms around his neck. Sea Hawk was actually an excellent dancer, he knew how to flawlessly lead and gracefully follow. She had learned that from the nights they’d spend dancing at bars and taverns in Seaworthy, back when she wasn’t Salineas’ ruler. Pretty much everyone at the castle had known that she frequently snuck out alone and even more frequently snuck out with Sea Hawk, none of them had ever mentioned it to her father tough.

After a while Mermista just let her mind shut off. Not focusing on anything besides how warm Sea Hawk’s touch felt and how his cologne perfectly mixed with the lingering scent of salt water and sweat.

Suddenly both of those things were gone, as everyone switched partners.

‘’Entrapta?” Since when did she dance? Did she even know how to?

The answer was, no. She was pretty shit at it, but she was trying her best at keeping up with Mermista’s lead, that counted for something; right?

‘’So I have talked to Adora, who apparently hasn’t seen anything.”

What was this about again?

‘’Our case.” Mermista hadn’t even realised that she’d been thinking out loud.

Oh right.

‘’For the love of gods does anyone know who stole those damn biscuits?” Mermista groaned as she trotted over to the bar, where most of her friends had gathered.

They looked around the room for a while before Adora blurted out: ‘’It was Micah!”

‘’WHAT-” Glimmer almost spilled wine on herself again, but Bow thankfully caught the glass before she could spill any more.

‘’Why am I not surprised?” Netossa sighed

‘’Yeah, the man was living on a wasteland for almost two whole decades, so I don’t know why any of you are surprised.” She deadpanned.

After everyone had calmed down, they decided to make their way up to the balcony of the castle. Everyone was choosing a spot on the abnormally large couch, making themselves comfortable. Some people taking the task way to serious, like Adora, who took her time to consider every one of her options closely, with Catra begging her to just sit down next to her.

Spinnerella came out with a tray of champagne and a glass of orange juice for Frosta, which made Mermista laugh because the girl was 17 now, and Mermista had been sneaking out and getting batshit drunk at that point. Apparently, she wasn't the only one that felt bad though, as Netossa gave her some of her drink behind her wife's back.

'I would like to give a little speech." Perfuma tapped at the edge of her glass with her fingernail, to gather everyone's attention. Originally Adora wanted to give the speech but the woman was too drunk to even bring out a coherent sentence, so her idea was quickly shut down. Mermista had personally forbid Sea Hawk from giving a speech. So they instead decided on Perfuma. 'I've been lucky enough to be friends with Mermista for many years and have been at many of her previous birthdays; from sleepovers when we were twelve to partying all night when she turned eighteen." Mermista smiled, that had been the first time Sea Hawk had met any of her friends. 'And I mostly want to thank her, we can probably all agree that Mermista is an extremely strong women and an incredibly loyal and caring friend, even if she's afraid to show it at times. So, thank you and I'm so glad we all get to spend another birthday with you." Mermista could feel the tears rolling down her cheek.

They clinked glasses and Mermista leaned back into Sea Hawks lap, his arms wrapping around her torso.

‘’Happy Birthday, dearest.”

She sighed contently, melting in his embrace.

End Notes

On their way home:
Entrapta seeing Micah steal her biscuits: MY BISCUITS!
Mermista: Let's just go home...

Thanks so much for reading! I hope you enjoyed it, comments are always very appreciated.

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